

KALE REALTY

THE FAQ IS NOT YOUR CONTRACT.

Motto Mortgage franchisees just found out the hard way.

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**A BROKERAGE
PROMISED A
FRANCHISE BRAND
WOULD KEEP
OPERATING, IN
WRITING, THIS
APRIL.**

By August, it stopped selling that franchise and started letting owners walk away.

THE PROMISE AGENTS REMEMBERED WAS A PRESS RELEASE. THE DOCUMENT THAT BINDS YOU IS DIFFERENT.

When Real and RE/MAX Holdings announced their merger in April 2026, both companies said Motto Mortgage, "the first and only national mortgage brokerage franchise brand in the U.S.," would keep operating under its current brand. By August, Real REMAX Group called it a strategic decision to stop selling new Motto Mortgage franchises, and existing franchisees can now mutually terminate their agreements. Nobody broke a law. The announcement was never a contract. It just felt like one at the time.

WHAT TO CHECK THIS WEEK IF YOU'RE AT ANY BRAND-AFFILIATED BROKERAGE:

- 1 Pull your ICA or franchise agreement.**
Not the announcement email, not the FAQ page. The document you actually signed.
- 2 Find the brand-continuity language, if any exists.**
Most agreements say nothing about how long a brand name has to stay in use.
- 3 Get the real answer in writing.**
Ask your broker what happens if the brand changes, and get the reply from them directly, not from a company-wide memo.

THE TAKEAWAY

A PRESS RELEASE ISN'T A PROMISE YOU CAN ENFORCE.

Your signed agreement is the only document that is.